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r/UCI • 3mo ago
Educational-Guitar44

Dorms

Hello! I just got into UCI and am seriously considering attending next year! I was wondering if any students could give me information on the dorms, as I am kind of confused about how it all works. I would preferably live in a double. What are my best options?

Edit: thank you everyone for your insight! i found it all very helpful :) I am going in undeclared but am leaning towards bio, so im thinking about middle earth, potentially a classic, but ive heard mesa is better. im an only child, and i have never shared my space, so i might go crazy with three other roommates ahahaha. honestly i would love biased opinions, i want to know the absolute truth about middle earth classics if anyone wants to share their experience!



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InvestigatorOnly3009 • 3mo ago

Ok here's my opinion on this and what I wish I knew.

1. You're going to read Mesa is more social. That's not necessarily correct. I live in Mesa classics and my hall is completely dead and I don't know anyone. All my friends are in middle earth so I spent a ton of time there.
2. Middle is full of stem majors like engineering while Mesa has a mix of everything else. I don't know why this is but it's facts.

r/UCI

Joined

UC Irvine

A place for UCI Anteaters, and anything UCI related. Discord: <https://discord.gg/uci>

[Created Sep 24, 2009](#)[Public](#)

45K

Anteaters

1.1K

Hunting for ants

USER FLAIR



Alternative-Shake-41

HELPFUL UCI LINKS

2022-23 Housing Megathread:

https://www.reddit.com/r/UCI/comments/vfp0la/uci_housing_megathread_20222023/

UCI Basic Needs:

<https://basicneeds.uci.edu/>

UCI Disability Services: <https://dsc.uci.edu/>

Borrow a Laptop:

<https://www.lib.uci.edu/mrc/mrc-laptops-and-mobile-devices>

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what u want to do. yes it might sound fun, but it becomes really old really quickly when you want to just chill sometimes. Uhh they also don't have bugs... it might have happened like 4 times in the entire year which is not an epidemic by any means.

4. Brandywine in middle is significantly better than anteater... if people say the opposite they straight up don't go here. yeah it has better desserts but they have like 1 thing like 50% of the time while Brandy always has stuff. Don't listen to other people bc they don't know ball 🤔



Unlucky_State_6788 • 3mo ago

Brandywine is not better than Anteater your deadass lying



ConversationMajor127 • 3mo ago

asseater came before bootywine.... just so yknow. one thing to note asseater froyo machine works more often then brandy's



Unlucky_State_6788 • 3mo ago

Freshman here at UCI (here are my inside tips)

1. Choose Mesa Court (more social and the food is way way way better, trust me it matters), the walking is manageable despite what anyone else says.
2. Doubles are fine, but if you can adjust Quads are Best, 1. They are cheapest
3. Bathroom shared by 8 people rather than whole floor with 2 showers and toilets. Also cleaned everyday.
4. Most space of all the floor plans
5. Lot of newer rooms and feels, classics feel older and also known to have more bugs and roaches. (Almost none in towers)

[More](#)

[Schedule of classes:](#)

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/perl/WebSoc>

[Register for classes:](#)

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/registrar/soc/webreg.html> (Academic year)

<https://summer.uci.edu/> (Summer)

[View fees and balances:](#)

<https://zotaccount.uci.edu/>

[Financial aid:](#)

<https://www.ofas.uci.edu/content/> (Log in on the left)

[Housing information:](#)

<https://housing.uci.edu/>

[Academic calendar:](#)

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/calendars/quarterly/2022-2023/quarterly22-23.html>

UCI PD: <https://www.police.uci.edu/>

R/UCI RULES

- 1 No Inflammatory Language or Harassment

Treat people with respect and argue in good faith.

- 2 No bigotry

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ipoopmyself123 • 3mo ago

how can a dorm be soocially more social i never understood that



StolenApollo • 3mo ago

Zot Tuah

It can't lmao this has always been a dumb take. Middle Earth had so many activities all the time and the common room was lively and fun. No idea where this idea started aside from dogpiling on stem majors just for the heck of it.



Unlucky_State_6788 • 3mo ago

Mesa Court towers are open plans so you can visit any floor, while middle earth you need a key for that specific floor



jjchwi • 3mo ago

You also need a key for specific floors in Mesa towers unless the floors are connected like 2nd to 3rd floor but after that you need a key to every other floor



Independent-Ad2443 • 3mo ago

Now tell them about the AC (or search for older posts).

3 No witch hunts

No posting information about a person or group in a way that encourages a witch hunt, doxxing, or harassment of anyone.

4 No naming TAs, students, and staff

Naming others without the explicit consent of the individual in your post will result in a ban. Staff and faculty are a gray area and will be subject to moderator judgment. Photos of lost items such as IDs should be censored.

5 No illegal activities/academic violations

This includes requests for pirated versions of textbooks and homework services.

6 Please read the FAQ before posting about lost items

Hide sensitive information on lost items <https://tinyurl.com/y3dqwc5q>

7 No non-UCI affiliated promotions

Posts seeking to use UCI students and faculty as a resource will be

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classes. The difference is in proximity to your classes, middle earth is closer to social sciences, engineering, and ics, while mesa is closer to humanities. Subsequently, mesa has more humanities-type people while middle earth has more stem-type people. The social life and food is better at mesa, but if you're in middle earth you can always just walk there every so often.

I would choose based on the type of people you want to hang out with. I would rather be with stem people so I chose middle earth towers, and it worked out great.



ConcentrateLeft546 • 3mo ago

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

Food is literally the exact same. Both dining halls are serviced by the exact same company.



Tenuous_Fawn • 3mo ago

Anteatery has better desserts, among other things. Brandywine has an extra entre option. The food is not literally the exact same.



Unlucky_State_6788 • 3mo ago

Wrong, Anteatery consistently has way better options on the weekdays. Brandywine is cheap food with lots of undercooked chicken, borderline uneatable



GapInfinite5304 • 2mo ago

I asked one of the BW managers, and it's the same menu cycle just different days. 4 weeks, rinse and repeat.



...these examples, leaving feedback, commissions, etc. UCI affiliated activities such as clubs and events, as well as survey requests from UCI members are allowed.

8 Do not use this subreddit as a platform for venting about interpersonal or political conflict

9 Users creating conflict that have not participated in the subreddit may be removed

SELF CARE LINKS

Reddit post of student emergency tools:
https://www.reddit.com/r/UCI/comments/w1ooph/how_to_request_assistance_in_a_time_of_crisis/

FREE COUNSELING SESSIONS:
<https://counseling.uci.edu/> A crisis care therapist is available to 24 hours a day 7 days a week.

24-hour national hotline: 1-800-273-8255

Not comfortable with speaking? Text to 741741 and someone will speak with you on the other end. Most major providers will waive texts sent to crisis text line and it will not appear on bills.

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stations and exculsive cycles



Disgraced-Academic • 3mo ago

Undergrad [2026]

There are the classic dorm buildings and the tower buildings. We have two dorm communities on campus and each has classics and towers. Classics are typically 2 person rooms with a few singles and triples. You have a "suite" of about 6 rooms that shares one large bathroom and a small study space + a large common area shared with the whole dorm (number of people varies but mine was ~70). There is also a laundry room. The towers are similar in amenities but they are newer and therefore nicer. The rooms are all 4 person set-ups and two rooms share one bathroom (aka 8 people to one bathroom). There is a large common space and a larger laundry room. The towers are cheaper, have newer stuff, and are closer to the cafeteria/campus but are more cramped. Dorms can be further from campus/cafeateria, are way older, and pricier but have the option for a single or double.



womenloverbot • 3mo ago

quads are the cheapest as others have said but honestly, unless you're besties with all 3 of your roommates, a quad is so frustrating. sharing one room with 3 people will really take a toll on you. i shared a room all my life but became very frustrated in the quad



Educational-Guitar44 **OP** • 3mo ago

this is what i'm worried about! i am an only child and i will acknowledge that im not used to sharing my space. i think i might go crazy in a quad, but i am also hearing that the towers are better so im stuck!



[x.php/pid803578](#)

or send an email to conduct@uci.edu

Medical Sevices, UCI SHIP alternative:

<https://www.shareourselves.org/>

and dental: <https://www.omidinstitute.org/>

<https://www.lestonnacfreeclinic.org/>

<https://familiestogetheroc.org/>

Communication services for low-income individuals:

<https://www.assurancewireless.com/>

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sharing the bathroom with 7 people versus around 12 is simpler. it's also easier to socialize but honestly if you're going to join clubs, you'll find people that way anyway. for privacy or personal space, towers are not better!!! what's your priority for dorms? if you don't mind the classics being a bit older and less social, i would say it's worth it for having more privacy.

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**abowlfoupp** • 3mo ago

i lived in mesa towers my first year and i'm an oldest sibling with a large age gap who's never shared a room. ik not the same as only child, but until college i had never shared my living space with anyone. i was the only one of my three roommates who was 1. a complete stranger, and 2. not from the area. i absolutely loved my dorm, my roommates and i got along really well and i never had any of the issues with maintenance that my friends in the classic had. also because the bathroom was shared by only 8 people, everyone was very clean (bc anyone who left a mess could be identified), the staff came once a week to clean our bathroom too! i took stem classes and GE's my first year and the walk really isn't bad at all (much prefer that over the bus rides from the apartments now). i know people are comparing the dining halls a bunch, but it's really not that big of a deal. your meal plan works at both dining halls so just go to whichever has the better options that day.

the most important thing about a quad is that you get along with your roommates. i got really lucky that a random person i met on instagram ended up working out and is still one of my best friends. you don't need to be best friends with your roommates though, make sure you're compatible as roommates before you start looking for friends!

i'm really sorry i think some of the grammar is horrible, ill try to edit it later....



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Living has more homely vibe to it and the food is exactly the same



Unhappy-Welder3281 • 3mo ago

I stayed in a Mesa Court double for orientation and am currently living in a Middle Earth double so here's my opinion for both:

Mesa Court - Cons: Unless you are a humanities or arts major, most of your classes are probably going to be very far away from the dorms, so it could take 20+ minutes to walk to class. I'm not sure if this is with all the dorms in Mesa Court, but at the one I stayed at the bathrooms were stalls (which I don't really like, not sure about you though) and the showers were glass door showers with literally nothing else meaning someone could technically see you inside the shower. The beds in the dorms had built in drawers underneath, unlike Middle Earth which doesn't have that, so not nearly as much stuff can be put under the beds there.

Pros: The rooms there are very big, the double I had was huge compared to my current one. The dorms are also more modern and the wardrobes were a lot better than the ones in Middle Earth. There is also a volleyball net, some exercise equipment (?) and other things outside around Mesa Court, so it's probably more social there.

Middle Earth - Cons: Supposedly there is a bug problem in Middle Earth classics, however I haven't seen a single bug in here ever so not sure. Dorms are smaller than Mesa Court and the furniture is a bit older, especially if you get one of the older dorms.

Pros: Way closer to classes if you are a STEM major, if you get one of the older buildings like Rivendell (where I am), the bathrooms and showers are more private, as they are big, single bathrooms rather than stalls. Middle Earth is pretty social, as a lot of people hang out in the recreation center, the basketball court, or the study room.



StolenApollo • 3mo ago

Zot Tuah

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First of all, do NOT get a triple. DO NOT. That's worst case scenario and a very bad idea. Second, do not get housing at the Middle Earth classics. They're not great and are not worth it.

If you really don't want a quad, Mesa Classics are an option for a double, but if I'm being honest with you, I've always had my own room growing up and the quad was a million times better.

My STRONG recommendation is to find 3 others online who don't seem like freaks and apply for a quad together. I've heard of a few cases of this ending badly but almost ever other case including my own was very positive. Additionally, the quads are significantly higher quality than any of the classics and it isn't even close.

If you're literally any stem majors, I urge you to choose Middle Earth. Some people say it's less social than Mesa and I'm really not sure where this rumor started but I think it's just general judgement about stem majors but it isn't true. The big advantage with Middle Earth is the proximity to classes. Some mornings, I'd wake up 5 minutes before a lecture and run out and my lecture was only a few hundred feet from home which is a game-changer. Middle Earth used to be the newer towers but Mesa recently added another tower so that isn't necessarily true, but I do find the quality of Middle Earth to be higher in the rooms, having seen both.

As for the dining halls, there's a lot of yap on this thread and this is a controversy but my personal opinion is that Brandywine is the superior dining hall. Asseatory sometimes has more options but Brandy's quality is way more consistent in general. Additionally, if you don't like whatever they're serving on a given day and want a grilled cheese sandwich or some sort of chicken sandwich, brandy makes them fresh while asseatory keeps them warm after making them in bulk so brandy is always better for those.

At the end of the day, there's no going wrong with any of these options but I will say that my general recommendation is this order:

1. ME Towers quad
2. Mesa Towers quad

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5. never get a triple 🤔🤔

Also, a few final notes I forgot to mention. Sharing a bathroom in the quads is MUCH nicer than the hall bathrooms in the classics and it isn't even close to comparable. They clean the bathrooms every day and do a nice clean once a week and since there are two of everything in there, it's realistically like having a bathroom for your room that 4 people use which isn't insane.

AC is another point some people brought up. The towers at Middle Earth didn't have AC and I don't think anything else has AC either, but the common room did have AC, so during those times in the year, you can actually get AC by leaving your room open and running the fan. That's what we did and it was perfectly fine. We literally never had temperature issues.



Educational-Guitar44 OP • 3mo ago

good to know, thank you! can i ask why getting a quad might be better than a triple? just curious about your opinion hahaha



StolenApollo • 3mo ago

Zot Tuah

I don't know if you've had a chance to see any of these rooms, but basically the quads are the only option in the towers. The towers are better than the classics in all cases. A triple at UCI is actually just a double with 3 ppl so you functionally get the worst of both worlds. You're in a classic, you have to share it with others, and it's still a small room (the quads are MUCH larger rooms).



Educational-Guitar44 OP • 3mo ago

ohhhh ok that makes sense, thank you!

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I lived in the Mesa Court classics a long time ago and loved it. Back then it was only two to a room. What I like most about my dorm is that it was freshmen only. Since we were all new to the school and had no friends going in, everybody was incentivized to meet other people, and you were all going through the same experience together.

We had a great RA who used to plan all kinds of activities both in the dorm and in the area, so it helped us get acclimated to our new hometown.

Mesa Court always felt friendlier than Middle Earth. I had friends who lived over there that said the same thing. It feels like Mesa has more open area, grass, trees, etc.

**CommunicationNo7384** • 3mo ago

if your gonna do a double go mesa middle earth is so buns socially unless your in towers which is quads only. quads are fun though mesa or mearth so try to get into one of those. mesa is a lot better socially and really isn't too far from classes if you don't mind the walk. just DON'T go into middle earth classics.

**One_Beautiful5168** • 3mo ago

My advice don't come here!

**PsychologicalSeat457** • 3mo ago

I lived in both middle earth and mesa court and significantly preferred Mesa court doubles! Luckily i roomed with a friend so that helped and dont have to super worry about sharing the space!



Create



Amans4 • 3mo ago

Ngl you should double in ACC or UTC apartments, on campus housing sucks. Great campus though, you will love your time here!